

AY25 PROGRAM ASSESSMENT REPORT

v2026.1

Tracking data

CIM code (e.g., ME-CM)	MS-IPSY-1
Program Name	MS in Industrial-Organizational Psychology
Assessment Year	AY 2024-2025
Program Assessment Coordinator	Kristina Bauer
Year of Current Assessment Plan	Fall 2016
No Assessment This Year per Plan	
LO(s) Assessed	1. Demonstrate basic knowledge in the three key areas of I/O psychology – personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics. 2. Clearly communicate (orally) information to a diverse group of business decision makers. 3. Apply I/O knowledge (i.e., personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics) to a work setting.
Presented at program authority meeting date:	10/15/2025
<i>Please attach minutes</i>	See Appendix A

Methodology

The rubrics for each artifact are provided in Appendix B.

1. Demonstrate knowledge of the basic principles of industrial and organizational psychology.
 - a. Artifact 1: Exams in PSYC 529 – Personnel Selection and Evaluation was taught by Scott Morris and covers a breadth of topics related to personnel psychology.
 - b. Artifact 2: Exams in PSYC 556 – Organizational Psychology was taught by Frank Shu and covers a breadth of topics related to organizational psychology.
 - c. Artifact 3: PSYC 545 – Graduate Statistics I was taught by Rob Keating and covers concepts related to research methods and statistics like probability, correlation, and regression.
 - d. Artifact 4: PSYC 546 – Graduate Statistics II was taught by Rob Keating and covers concepts related to research methods and statistics like t-test, ANOVA, and non-parametric statistics.
 - e. Artifact 5: PSYC 511 – Psychometric Theory was taught by Alan Mead and covers concepts related to research methods and statistics like reliability, validity, and test construction.
 - f. Exams are graded within their respective semesters by the instructors of each course.
 - g. Assessment Categories:
 - i. Does not meet expectations: Students who demonstrate knowledge of less than 70% of the tested content across exams.

- ii. Meets expectations, but some weak areas: Students who demonstrate knowledge of 70-80% of the tested content across exams.
 - iii. Meets expectations: Students who demonstrate knowledge of 80%-90% of the tested content across exams.
 - iv. Exceeds expectations: Students who demonstrate knowledge of >90% of the tested content across exams.
- 2. Clearly communicate (orally) information to a diverse group of business decision makers.
 - a. Artifact: Internship presentation evaluations – When students complete an internship, they enroll in at least three credits of PSYC 558. Roya Ayman is the instructor of record for the course each semester. Internships are 3-month, half time positions in I/O or HR at a variety of companies. At the end of the semester in which students take their final credit hour, they give a presentation about their internship.
 - b. At the end of each semester, students give their internship presentations. At that time, two I/O faculty members, Roya Ayman and Kristina Bauer, rate each presentation and come to a consensus rating using the Oral Communication Rubric.
 - c. Assessment Categories:
 - i. Does not meet expectations: Students who receive a rating <2 on either dimension.
 - ii. Meets expectations: Students who receive an average rating <3.0 with at least a 2 rating on each dimension.
 - iii. Exceeds expectations: Students who receive a 3 rating of three on both dimensions.
- 3. Apply I/O knowledge (i.e., personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics) to a work setting.
 - a. Artifact: Internship supervisor evaluations—When students complete an internship, they enroll in at least three credits of PSYC 558. Roya Ayman is the instructor of record for the course each semester. Internships are 3-month, half time positions in I/O or HR at a variety of companies.
 - i. At the end of the internship, the student's internship supervisor completes the Internship Evaluation Form.
 - ii. The assessment categories are:
 - 1. Does not meet expectations: Students who receive a rating <3 on any item.
 - 2. Meets expectations: Students who receive an average rating <4.0 with at least a 3 rating on each item.
 - 3. Exceeds expectations: Students who receive an average rating ≥4.0 with at least a 3 rating on each item.

Results

This report is a full evaluation of three years of program data, per the assessment plan. The results presented below are the combined assessment results for AY 2022-2023, AY 2023-2024, and AY 2024-2025.

Artifact samples

Please see Appendix C for artifact samples.

Data table

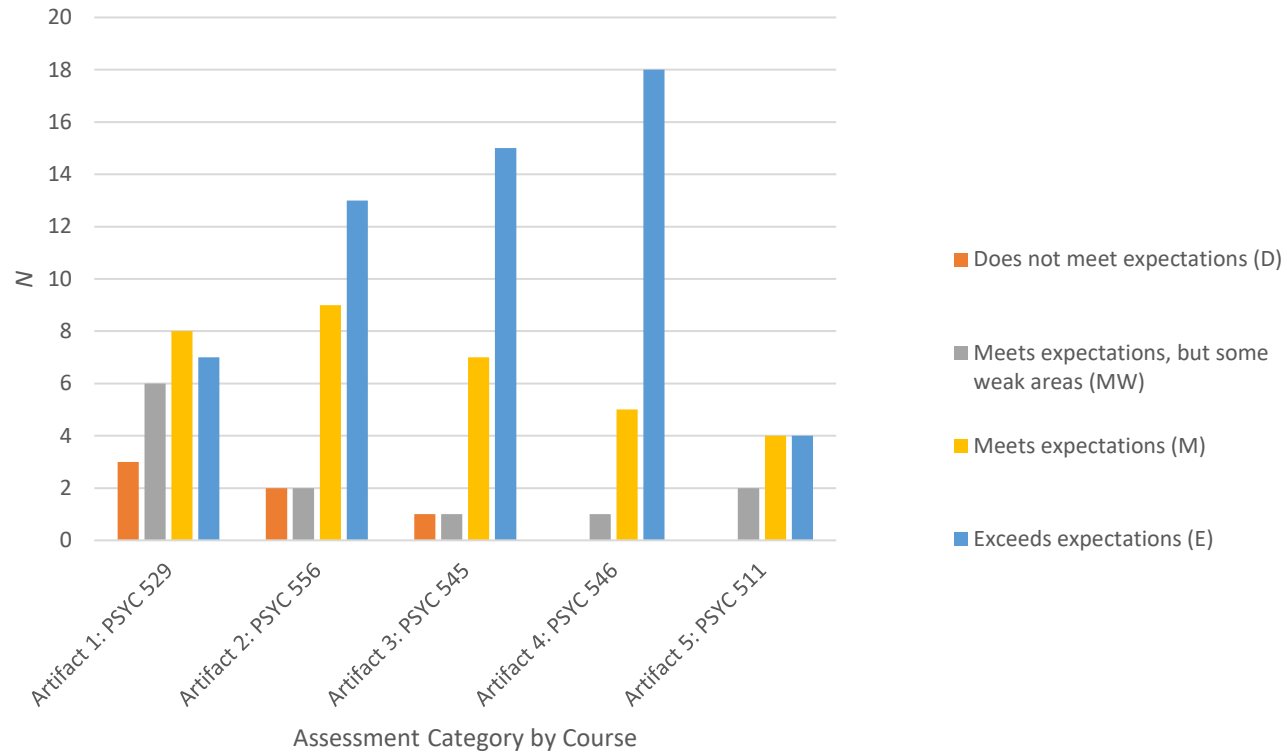
Learning Outcome 1

Demonstrate basic knowledge in the three key areas of I/O psychology – personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics.

Class or other requirement:	Exam Performance		Artifact 1: PSYC 529		Artifact 2: PSYC 556		Artifact 3: PSYC 545		Artifact 4: PSYC 546		Artifact 5: PSYC 511	
AY:	2022-2025	Category	<i>N</i>	%	<i>N</i>	%	<i>N</i>	%	<i>N</i>	%	<i>N</i>	%
Program:	MS-IPSY-1	Does not meet expectations (D)	3	13%	2	8%	1	4%	0	0%	0	0%
LO#:	1	Meets expectations, but some weak areas (MW)	6	25%	2	8%	1	4%	1	4%	2	20%
Assessor:	Instructors of Record	Meets expectations (M)	8	33%	9	35%	7	29%	5	21%	4	40%
Rubric:	Assessment of Knowledge in PSYC [###]	Exceeds expectations (E)	7	29%	13	50%	15	63%	18	75%	4	40%
# assessed:	varies	Total	24		26		24		24		10	

Note. Sample size for PSYC 556 is higher due to student's retaking the course; sample size is smaller for PSYC 511 due to varying cohort sizes

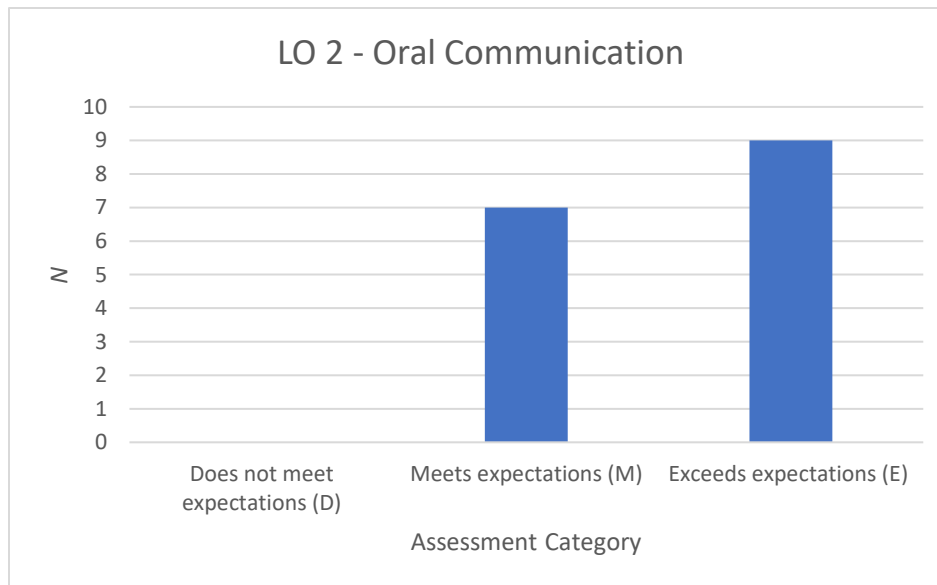
LO 1 - Exam Performance



Learning Outcome 2

Clearly communicate (orally) information to a diverse group of business decision makers.

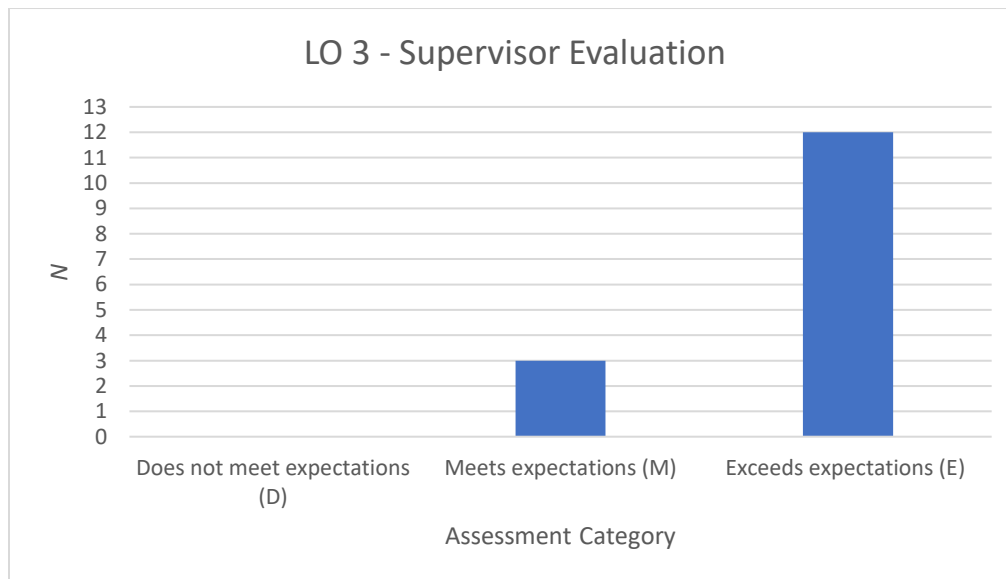
Class or other requirement:	Supervisor Evaluation	Category	<i>N</i>	%
AY:	2022-2025	Does not meet expectations (D)	0	0%
Program:	MS-IPSY-1	Meets expectations (M)	7	44%
LO#:	3	Exceeds expectations (E)	9	56%
Assessor:	Supervisor			
Rubric:	Internship Evaluation Form			
# assessed:	16			



Learning Outcome 3

Apply I/O knowledge (i.e., personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics) to a work setting.

Class or other requirement:	Supervisor Evaluation	Category	<i>N</i>	%
AY:	2022-2025	Does not meet expectations (D)	0	0%
Program:	MS-IPSY-1	Meets expectations (M)	3	20%
LO#:	3	Exceeds expectations (E)	12	80%
Assessor:	Supervisor			
Rubric:	Internship Evaluation Form			
# assessed:	15			



Description of findings

Learning Objective 1: Demonstrate basic knowledge in the three key areas of I/O psychology – personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics.

Key Finding: There appears to be some variability in knowledge levels in the three key areas of I/O psychology. Unlike the last full review where there were potential knowledge gaps in organizational psychology, students seem to have knowledge gaps in personnel psychology (PSYC 529) with 63% meeting or exceeding expectations, 25% meeting expectations but with some weak areas, and 13% not meeting expectations. Students appear to have better knowledge in organizational psychology (PSYC 556, 85% met or exceeded expectations) and research methods and statistics (PSYC 545, 546, and 511; 92%, 96%, & 80% met or exceeded expectations).

In personnel, the majority were meeting expectations, but the overall performance was lower than desired. Based on exam performance the faculty did not see consistent or specific knowledge/skill gaps. There was a pattern of improvement across exams, such that most students scored lower on the first exam and higher on the second exam. This suggests students became familiar with course expectations.

Learning Objective 2: Clearly communicate (orally) information to a diverse group of business decision makers.

Key Finding: Across the three academic years, students were able to orally communicate information to a diverse audience. All students met or exceeded expectations. This is similar to the last two assessment periods (95% & 96% of students met expectations during 2019-2022 and 2016-2019, respectively). Note that the assessment categories were different in previous reports (i.e., 2 categories: met or did not meet expectations). The goal is to have students continue to meet or exceed expectations at a similar rate as this assessment report.

Learning Objective 3: Apply I/O knowledge (i.e., personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics) to a work setting.

Key Finding: Students are very successful at applying I/O knowledge to work settings. In particular, all students across three academic years met or exceeded expectations on the supervisor evaluation form used to evaluate internship performance. In fact, 80% of students exceeded expectations. The goal is to continue to have students meet or exceed expectations at a similar rate as this assessment report.

Continuous Improvement, CI, plans

The purpose of assessment is to improve the quality of our educational programs. The most important part of the assessment cycle is how we use the data to improve our programs. Examine the data provided above describing student achievement, and if areas for possible improvement emerge, describe plans to achieve this improvement.

Prior CI plan impact

Last year, the IO program reported concerns about faculty turnover and availability of Artifact 1 Case Studies for LO3 (applying knowledge). We discussed how to deal with potential missing data and whether the artifact was necessary. Ultimately, until additional tenure track faculty can be hired, the program has decided to rely on one artifact for LO3, that is, the supervisor evaluations. Supervisor evaluations represent the culmination of the LO, and can therefore be used without additional metrics.

This cycle's CI plan

Given the lack of consistency in faculty offering core courses, there is concern about delivering consistently high-quality educational experiences. We will continue discussing and strategizing ways to ensure consistent training and comparable assessment results.

Appendix A

I-O Program Meeting Minutes

Present: Scott Morris (Program Director), Roya Ayman, Kristina Bauer, Rob Keating

- Briefly reviewed metrics before moving to the 3-year data.
- Discussed the need for additional artifacts for LO1. Scott agreed to provide the additional artifacts for the Does Not Meet, Meets but Weak Areas, and Exceeds Expectations categories.
- The IO program reviewed the tables of results along with the corresponding description of findings. Performance on LO2 and LO3 were strong – consensus of all program committee members. The lower knowledge in personnel was agreed upon as a concern. However, there were still a majority of students who met or exceeded expectations.
 - Scott described his review of exams for patterns in knowledge/skill gaps. There were no patterns. The only pattern was improvement across exams.
 - We agreed that knowledge scores were lower than desired but growth was a positive sign.
- Reviewed previous CI plans and agreed there continues to be a concern in the stability of available instructors. We agreed to continue to strive to find ways to deliver consistently high-quality instruction.

Appendix B

Rubrics Described in this Report

Assessment of Knowledge of Personnel Psychology in PSYC 529

Students in PSYC529 complete two exams covering knowledge of personnel psychology. Exam questions sample knowledge of terminology and understanding of key principles, theories, methodologies in the following content areas:

Exam 1

- Job Analysis
- Job Performance and Performance Appraisal
- Psychometrics and Reliability
- Test Validation

Exam 2

- Test construction
- Item Analysis
- Cognitive Ability Testing
- Test Bias and Fairness
- Employment Discrimination
- Selection System Design
- Test Utility
- Design and Evaluation of Training Programs

Assessment of Knowledge of Organizational Psychology in PSYC 556

Students in Psyc 556 complete two exams covering knowledge of Organizational Psychology. Exam question samples knowledge of terminology and understanding of key principles, theories, and research methodologies in the following content areas:

Exam 1

- Research method
- Organizational structure and its interface with the environment
- Content Theories of Motivation
- Process Theories of Motivation
- Organizational Attitudes (e.g., satisfaction, stress, commitment, engagement) or behaviors (e.g. Turnover, absenteeism, organizational citizenship)

Exam 2

- Group structure
- Group dynamics
- Leadership styles
- Leadership in context
- Training
- Organizational change management

Assessment of Knowledge of Research Methods and Statistics in PSYC 545

Students in PSYC545 complete four exams covering knowledge of statistics and selected data analyses. Exams sample knowledge of terminology and understanding of key principles, and methods in the following content areas:

Exam 1

- Introduction to R
- Describing quantitative data
- Standardization
- Probability
- Sampling distributions and confidence intervals
- Inference and Hypothesis testing
- Common assumptions and biases
- Power and effect size

Exam 2

- Correlation and simple linear regression
- Multiple regression including assumptions and diagnostics
- Advanced multiple regression (MR)
 - MR – Hypothesis Testing
 - MR – Hierarchical Regression
 - MR – Categorical Predictors
 - MR – Mediation and Moderation
- Logistic Regression
- Missing data

Assessment of Knowledge of Research Methods and Statistics in PSYC 546

Students in PSYC546 complete three exams covering knowledge of graduate level statistics. Exams sample knowledge of terminology and understanding of key principles, theories, methodologies in the following content areas:

Exam 1

- Review of inference, estimation, sampling distributions
- T-tests
- Oneway analysis of variance (ANOVA): Comparing means across more than two groups; Partitioning variance
- Post-hoc tests and planned contrasts
- ANOVA assumptions
- Comparing ANOVA & regression
- ANCOVA and assumptions

Exam 2

- Factorial Designs
- Within-subjects & Repeated Measures ANOVA
- Mixed Design ANOVA
- Chi-square and other Non-parametric Tests
- Power and sample size estimation

Assessment of Knowledge of Research Methods and Statistics in PSYC 511

Students in PSYC511 complete one (or two) exam covering knowledge of psychometric concepts. Exam questions sample knowledge of terminology and understanding of key principles, theories, methodologies, and applications in the following content areas:

Exam 1

- Fundamental Measurement Principles
- Item Writing
- Test Construction
- Reliability
- Generalizability Theory
- Agreement
- Item Analysis

Exam 2

- Factor Analysis (EFA and CFA)
- Item Response Theory
- Item Bias/Differential Item Functioning
- Validity
- Test Bias and Fairness

Assessment Rubric for Oral Communication

	Oral Communication			Rating
	1 – Below Expectations	2 – Meets Expectations	3 – Exceeds Expectations	
Mechanics	Structure unclear; Main points unclear; Uninteresting slides; Hard to read/ understand; Numerous errors	Satisfactory structure and organization; Main points well stated; Transitions may be unclear; Satisfactory slides; Easy to read; Few errors	Superb structure and organization; Main points well stated; Arguments easy to follow; Engaging slides; Greatly assist in message delivery; No errors	
Delivery	Cannot be understood; Awkward gestures/body language; Minimal eye contact with audience; Not able to answer committee questions without help from Chair	Clear voice; Few distracting gestures; Good eye contact; Competently answer questions and committee members' comments with some help from Chair	Confident delivery; Enhances the message through inflection, volume, pace; Engaging interaction with committee members; Answers questions independently and confidently with no help from Chair	

Case Study Feedback

This rubric is used for the two cases in PSYC 556 and the scores are summed across the two cases for assessment purposes.

1. Writing style and organization (2)
2. Coverage of the expectancy theory of motivation/ contingency model of leadership (1.5)
3. Application to case diagnosis and recommendation (1.5)
4. Coverage of the other theory of motivation/ leadership (1.5)
5. Application of theory to the case diagnosis and/or recommendation (1.5)
6. Integration of the two theories (how similar and different they are and how they can complement each other) (2)

Total: 10

Internship Evaluation Form – Supervisor

I. Directions

1. Read each statement below and rate the importance of that item to the successful completion of this internship according to the following scale: 1 = Little Importance; 2 = Somewhat Important; 3 = Very Important.
2. For each statement below, circle the number which best corresponds to your evaluation of this intern's performance. If there has been no opportunity to observe a particular performance factor, circle 0 (Not Applicable).

PERFORMANCE STATEMENT

Scale: 0 1 2 3 4 5
N/A Unacceptable Marginal Meets Exceeds
 Requirements Requirements Outstanding

Importance

- | | | |
|-------|----|--|
| _____ | 1. | Arrives on time for daily or scheduled activities. |
| | | 0 1 2 3 4 5 |
| _____ | 2. | Completes assignments within designated time frame. |
| | | 0 1 2 3 4 5 |
| _____ | 3. | Plans and organizes own time effectively. |
| | | 0 1 2 3 4 5 |
| _____ | 4. | Performs tasks with minimal supervision. |
| | | 0 1 2 3 4 5 |
| _____ | 5. | Demonstrates initiative in approaching and carrying out assignments. |
| | | 0 1 2 3 4 5 |
| _____ | 6. | Makes effective use of available resources (e.g., staff, equipment, reference materials) |
| | | 0 1 2 3 4 5 |
| _____ | 7. | Assumes a practical orientation to business realities. |
| | | 0 1 2 3 4 5 |
| _____ | 8. | Generates alternative approaches/solutions to problem solving. |
| | | 0 1 2 3 4 5 |
| _____ | 9. | Demonstrates technical competence in area of expertise. |
| | | 0 1 2 3 4 5 |

- _____ 10. Produces professional quality work.
0 1 2 3 4 5
- _____ 11. Clearly expresses technical or complex information to others outside his/her field of expertise.
0 1 2 3 4 5
- _____ 12. Relates to others in a non-condescending manner (not a know-it-all).
0 1 2 3 4 5
- _____ 13. Makes formal presentations in a well organized and professional manner.
0 1 2 3 4 5
- _____ 14. Maintains good interpersonal relationships with co-workers.
0 1 2 3 4 5
- _____ 15. Uses oral communication skills effectively.
0 1 2 3 4 5
- _____ 16. Uses written communication skills effectively.
0 1 2 3 4 5

II. Comments

1. How would you summarize this individual's performance strengths?

2. What suggestions do you have for improving this individual's professional skills?

Appendix C

Learning Outcome 1: Demonstrate basic knowledge in the three key areas of I/O psychology – personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics.

Does Not Meet Expectations Artifact Sample

Grade by question

Results

60%

Score

60

Out of 100 points

02:32:39

Time for this attempt

1

8 / 8 points

Definition: Job evaluation

Job evaluation is a systematic process that attempts to identify the relative value of jobs within an organization and establish an internally aligned pay equity structure accordingly. Job evaluation utilizes information produced by job analysis, such as job description, job specifications, and job-related competencies, to infer relative worth of the roles by incorporating compensable factors in point (factor), classification, or ranking methods.

Correct

8

/ 8 points

2

4 / 8 points

Definition: Criterion contamination

Criterion contamination means that the rated criteria are affected by non-controllable or non-job-specific factors. Criterion contamination examples include economy or market well-being.

Graded

Feedback

Feedback from grader

Extent to which a criterion measure reflects factors other than the intended conceptual outcome variable.

4

/ 8 points

3

4 / 8 points

Definition: Standard error of measurement

Standard error of measurement means the difference between the observed score and the expected score in a measurement.

Graded

Feedback

Feedback from grader

Standard deviation of scores due to random measurement error. Indicates how much on average an observed test score is expected to differ from the true score

4

/ 8 points

4

6 / 8 points

Definition: Critical incidents technique

Critical incidents technique is a type of method used in job analysis to collect information about a job. It is used to capture effective and ineffective job behavior and can infer the contextual competencies needed in performing this job.

Graded

Feedback

Feedback from grader

Job analysis method based on asking SMEs to describe specific incidents of particularly good or bad performance, including information about the context, actions and consequences.

6

/ 8 points

5

0 / 8 points

Definition: Range restriction

Range restriction refers to the limitation on the number of items and the test length to ensure that the degree of internal consistency does not come from item redundancy or a long test.

Incorrect

Feedback

Feedback from grader

Data with a limited range of test scores relative to the applicant population, due to selection decisions that directly or indirectly screen out those with low test scores. Leads to underestimates of criterion-related validity.

0

/ 8 points

6

13 / 15 points

Short Answer: Define and distinguish among the terms knowledge, skill, and ability. Given an example of each.

Knowledge is a person's cognitive gain in a specific subject. Knowledge could be acquired through education, training, and experience. For example, understanding the process of developing a research proposal could be a kind of knowledge. Skill is something one can learn and acquire over time, effectively incorporating the knowledge into performing relevant tasks. For instance, communication and decision-making could both be useful and trainable skills in leadership. Ability is more innate, biological, and dispositional compared to skill. Ability shows the capacity of how easily a person can acquire a skill. For example, problem-solving and interpersonal relationships could both be critical abilities needed for a consulting role.

Graded

Feedback

Feedback from grader

Whether ability is innate is a matter of some debate. A more useful distinction is that abilities tend to be resistant to change and generalizable, whereas skills are more trainable and task-specific.

Examples could have been more effectively used to demonstrate your understanding of these distinctions.

13

/ 15 points

7

0 / 15 points

Short Answer: Describe two distinct ways you could estimate the reliability of scores from an employment interview. Be specific about the data you would need to collect for each method.

The reliability of scores from an employment interview could be estimated through Multi-Trait Multi-Method (MTMM) matrix and factor analysis. For MTMM matrix, we will need to collect the correlation coefficient between the rated scores and the items on the matrix. We can even infer groupings in different dimensions of knowledge, skills, or abilities. For factor analysis, we would also need to collect the regression coefficient to support the convergent (high correlation) and discriminant (weak correlation) evidence.

Incorrect.

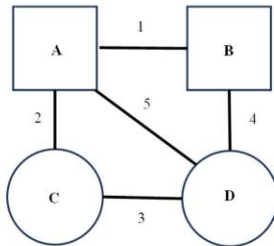
0

/ 15 points

Essay Answer only 1 of the following 2 questions. The answer should be structured as a formal essay, including complete well-formed paragraphs and a logical overall structure. Be sure that all concepts are fully explained, and that you provide a thorough rationale for all choices and conclusions (30 pts).

1. You have been hired to develop a system for assessing the job performance of ITS helpdesk staff (technology support staff) at IIT. Helpdesk staff respond to phone calls and emails from students, faculty and staff regarding technical problems (e.g., network connectivity, portal access, classroom technology failures), assist callers in solving common problems, and pass on more complex problems to appropriate technology specialists. The director of HR has expressed concerns that the current system relies on subjective supervisor ratings that are plagued by leniency and halo errors, resulting in ratings that are not useful in employee development. Discuss the pros and cons of supervisor ratings versus objective performance data. What steps should be taken to enhance the quality of supervisor ratings and their usefulness for providing developmental feedback. If your recommendations would depend on unknown information, describe how you would gather information to support your choices.
2. Describe the Binning & Barrett (1989) Unitarian model of test validity, and define each component of the model. Define the three major types of validity evidence, and how each type relates to the Unitarian model. Consider a multiple-choice knowledge test of student financial aid laws and regulations, which will be used for selecting University financial aid counselors. Using this context, provide a concrete example of each type of validity evidence, being specific about the data to be gathered and the data analysis.

If it is helpful, you can refer to the following figure when answering this question (this is optional).



While IIT is set on employing supervisor ratings as their main method of performance review, it is crucial to understand that there are pros and cons to both subjective supervisor ratings and objective performance data. The advantages of supervisor ratings include the comprehensiveness of employees' performance, and that they provide more contextual information rather than merely using quantifiable outcomes to determine employees' job performance. Supervisor ratings can also take employees' individual differences and other environmental factors into account, distinguishing employee efforts without focusing solely on quantifiable achievement. However, the biggest disadvantage of supervisor ratings is that they could be prone to rater biases, in this case, leniency and halo error. Leniency occurs when supervisors provide overly generous or inflated ratings. Halo errors occur when supervisors rate based on their overall impression of an employee, instead of the employee's specific performance on job-related tasks.

On the other hand, since objective performance data is quantifiable, it is easier to set clear performance standards and expectations, which could lead to greater transparency, employee accountability, and legal defensibility. It could also avoid suffering from rater biases, which, as a result, is easier to establish reliability and consistency. Objective performance data also possesses limitations, though. It cannot examine the comprehensive performance and consider contextual factors as a subjective rating.

In the case of enhancing the quality of supervisor ratings and their usefulness for providing developmental feedback, there are a few things that IIT could consider implementing. To begin with, Frame-Of Reference (FOR) training could be conducted on these supervisors (or raters) regularly. FOR is a type of training that educates raters on common evaluation standards. This could help solve the problem of leniency by establishing standardized rating expectations and guidelines. FOR is also proven empirically as one of the most effective methods to help reduce rating bias errors.

In addition to FOR, IIT could consider using Behavioral Anchored Rating Scale (BARS) to solve the issue of the Halo effect. BARS is a standardized performance rating tool that focuses on employees' performance on specific job tasks. With BARS, supervisors could be guided to provide judgement with items that closely align with employees' job tasks or responsibilities and rate with clear and discriminantly defined anchors on the scale. This could prevent raters from detouring from performance to impression.

Besides FOR and BARS, one other important approach is to regularly monitor the productivity of the evaluation system, collect raters and ratees' feedback, and reassess the system according to the present environmental conditions and organizational needs. Constant reassessment, reflection, and optimization are needed to ensure the product that the system provides remains fair, meaningful, practical, and acceptable to employees.

To optimize the current performance system requires a mix of different adjustment actions. Willing to reexamine what is effective and what is ineffective in its system and seek improvement has already put IIT in the achiever's lane. Combining FOR, BARS, and continuous reassessment could surely make IIT a better organization with a more successful employee development, more productive outcomes, and more satisfied stakeholders.

Graded

Feedback

Feedback from grader

Does not mention criterion contamination and deficiency, but discussed indirectly.

How do leniency and halo impact the utility of ratings?

Elaborate on the cons of objective measures.

Details of recommended methods (FOR, BARS) should be more fully described.

No discussion of how to deliver feedback.

25

/ 30 points

Fudge Points

Manually adjust the score by adding positive or negative points to this box.

0

Final Score

60 / 100

Meets Expectations but Some Weak Areas Artifact Sample

Grade by question

Results

76%
Score

76
Out of 100 points

02:16:24
Time for this attempt

1

7 / 8 points

Definition: Job evaluation

Job Evaluation is the process of systematically assessing the relative value of positions within an organization to establish an internally equitable compensation system.

Graded

Feedback

Feedback from grader
Using job analysis data

7 / 8 points

2

7 / 8 points

Definition: Criterion contamination

Variance due to systematic error, raters' bias, etc. that can be measured, but are not related to organizational goals/measurement objectives. Similar to confounders. (Please refer to the diagram on the test paper.)

Graded

Feedback

Feedback from grader
Diagram conveys the distinction between measure and construct, but does not correctly depict contamination.

7 / 8 points

3

7 / 8 points

Definition: Standard error of measurement

Theoretically, SEM is the standard deviation of the distribution of measurements after countless measurements. $SEM = SD_s \sqrt{1 - r_{xx}}$. Based on the SEM, subject scores and critical Z values, we can obtain confidence intervals for subject scores.

Graded

Feedback

Feedback from grader

Due to random measurement error/unreliability

7

/ 8 points

4

0 / 8 points

Definition: Critical incidents technique

Critical incident technique refers to the method of assessing performance with the help of typical/representative behaviors in the workplace as anchors, using behaviors of different qualities to be linked to corresponding scores. Alternatively, during the interview process, use the critical incident method to ask the subject about an event in his or her past experience (often relevant to the information the job required KSAOs) and use the subject's responses (STAR) to obtain relevant information (subject characteristics, response style, etc.)

Incorrect

Feedback

Feedback from grader

Job analysis method based on asking SMEs to describe specific incidents of particularly good or bad performance, including information about the context, actions and consequences.

0

/ 8 points

5

4 / 8 points

Definition: Range restriction

Due to the initial measurement, the sample was filtered, resulting in scores that were somewhat biased on subsequent measurements (generally tending to be higher).

Graded

Feedback

Feedback from grader

Scores are not biased. Rather, the analysis sample is not representative of the applicant population.

Data with a limited range of test scores relative to the applicant population, due to selection decisions that directly or indirectly screen out those with low test scores. Leads to underestimates of criterion-related validity.

4

/ 8 points

6

14 / 15 points

Short Answer: Define and distinguish among the terms knowledge, skill, and ability. Given an example of each.

Knowledge (Know What) refers to information, facts, concepts, and theories acquired through study, training, education, or experience. Knowing music theory and being able to recognize piano sheet music is knowledge.

Skill (Know How) is the degree of proficiency demonstrated in applying knowledge to real-world situations, usually acquired through repetition and practice. Playing the piano is skill.

Ability (Can Do) refers to an individual's inherent potential and talent for accomplishing a task or solving a problem. Finger dexterity and coordination are abilities.

Graded

Feedback

Feedback from grader

Whether ability is innate is a matter of debate. Better to describe as broad/generalizable and stable/resistant to change.

Great example.

14

/ 15 points

7

12 / 15 points

Short Answer: Describe two distinct ways you could estimate the reliability of scores from an employment interview. Be specific about the data you would need to collect for each method.

The first way to measure the reliability is the test-retest method. Firstly the questionnaire is designed at the time before the interview, we can identify the required KSAOs with the help of job analysis design items based on these, and subsequently administer it to the applicant at the interview. After the recruitment process is completed and the employee has been working for some time, the same questionnaire is administered again and the reliability (correlation coefficient) of the results of the two measurements is calculated.

The second method is the inter-rater reliability method. First, we recruit Subject Matter Experts, usually expert practitioners in the area of the job, supervisors, and outside experts (optional), to work together to design an objective rating scale (e.g., a behaviorally anchored rating scale) for a particular job. The raters then rate the interviewers and calculate the correlation coefficient between multiple raters' scores to verify the reliability of the score. The premise of this approach assumes that each rater is equivalent to a parallel measure.

Graded

Feedback

Feedback from grader

For test-retest, its unclear what scores are being correlated. Confusing reference to questionnaire vs interview.

Both methods require multiple measurements of the same group of interviewees (not just one).

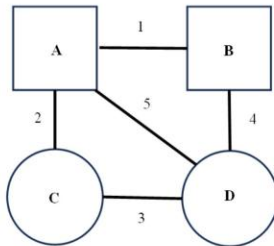
12

/ 15 points

Essay Answer only 1 of the following 2 questions. The answer should be structured as a formal essay, including complete well-formed paragraphs and a logical overall structure. Be sure that all concepts are fully explained, and that you provide a thorough rationale for all choices and conclusions (30 pts).

1. You have been hired to develop a system for assessing the job performance of OTS helpdesk staff (technology support staff) at IIT. Helpdesk staff respond to phone calls and emails from students, faculty and staff regarding technical problems (e.g., network connectivity, portal access, classroom technology failures), assist callers in solving common problems, and pass on more complex problems to appropriate technology specialists. The director of HR has expressed concerns that the current system relies on subjective supervisor ratings that are plagued by leniency and halo errors, resulting in ratings that are not useful in employee development. Discuss the pros and cons of supervisor ratings versus objective performance data. What steps should be taken to enhance the quality of supervisor ratings and their usefulness for providing developmental feedback. If your recommendations would depend on unknown information, describe how you would gather information to support your choices.
2. Describe the Binning & Barrett (1989) Unitarian model of test validity, and define each component of the model. Define the three major types of validity evidence, and how each type relates to the Unitarian model. Consider a multiple-choice knowledge test of student financial aid laws and regulations, which will be used for selecting University financial aid counselors. Using this context, provide a concrete example of each type of validity evidence, being specific about the data to be gathered and the data analysis.

If it is helpful, you can refer to the following figure when answering this question (this is optional).



Advantages of supervisor ratings:

- Supervisors have longer contact with subordinate employees, providing more opportunities for observation.
- They can gather more detailed information about the performance of their subordinates.
- Supervisors are more familiar with the job content.
- The ability to give personalized feedback positively impacts employee self-development and progress.

Disadvantages of supervisor ratings:

- The perspective can be one-sided.
- Granting too much discretion to supervisors may not be beneficial for employees.
- The scoring process lacks transparency, which can make it less convincing and may risk issues of fairness.
- The evaluation process is more cumbersome and time-consuming.
- Evaluations are more likely to require supervisors to extract memories or judgement of an employee's behavior, which can lead to distorted data.
- A variety of subjective rating errors, such as:
 - Halo effect (giving high ratings to favored employees, not based on their actual performances)
 - Leniency (giving high ratings to all subordinates)/Severity error (giving low ratings to all subordinates)
 - Bias/discrimination (Personal biases affecting ratings)

- Proximal effect (evaluating performance only in terms of recent performance)
- Median effect (all ratings are close to the midpoint, and there is no way to distinguish between employees with different performance).
- Comparison error (comparing employees to each other rather than to objective criteria)
- Neutralization effect (all ratings converge to the midpoint and do not distinguish between employees with different performance).

Advantages of objective performance data:

- Objective performance data allows for standardized measurements and reduces errors.
- Data is easily accessible, saving human, material, and financial resources, and it is simple to store & recall.
- Objective data enables comparisons, allowing employees to self-reflect and improve.
- The scoring process is relatively open and transparent and can demonstrate procedural fairness.
- Scoring criteria are flexible and can be tailored to meet organizational goals.
- Generally, it offers higher reliability and validity.

Disadvantages of objective performance data:

- The initial process of developing objective performance indicators and criteria can be labor-intensive.
- Lack of access (only scores) to detailed performance data limits feedback and employee self-development.
- Rater scores may still contain subjective errors, necessitating rater training.
- Any updates to performance standards must be communicated to all employees and must be reasonable and legal to ensure acceptability.

Steps to Enhance the Quality of Supervisor Ratings for Developmental Feedback:

- Improve the reliability and validity of measurements, review performance appraisal metrics and guidelines to ensure they encompass all aspects of an employee's performance and align with organizational goals. The process should be standardized, transparent, and reflective of actual performance. Relevant information can be sourced from job analysis and evaluation.
- Utilize specific behaviors as rating criteria, such as Behaviorally Anchored Rating Scales, to enhance objectivity. (Information can be gathered from SEMs, Focus Groups, Job description)
- Train raters to minimize rating errors influenced by subjective factors. Provide specialized training on rating criteria, rating scales, and common biases.
- Help evaluators calibrate their judgments through case studies.
- Conduct simulated ratings before the formal assessment to identify and correct errors. This also serves as a method to revise scoring criteria.
- Allow employees to access performance audits, answer questions about their appraisal results, and submit them for review.
- Perform statistical analysis of scoring data regularly to identify and correct systematic deviations. (Data of previous performance appraisals will be gathered)
- Conduct random checks and discussions of scoring results to ensure consistency.
- Encourage supervisors to give feedback focused on performance behaviors rather than personal traits. Ensure feedback is constructive and encourages employee participation.
- Synthesize results from multiple performance appraisals for each employee, observe performance changes over time, and provide tailored feedback accordingly.
- Incorporate multiple perspectives in evaluations, such as 360-degree feedback. By combining insights from various sources, supervisors can gain a deeper understanding of employees and provide more comprehensive feedback.

Graded

Feedback

Feedback from grader

Not structured as an essay.

In the advantages of supervisor, it is not clear what you are comparing to. These don't seem to provide a clear contrast to objective measures.

Definition of Halo is inaccurate.

Unclear what you mean by higher validity for objective measures.

Limited discussion of the cons of objective measures. Does not address contamination and deficiency.

Good recommendations.

25 / 30 points

Fudge Points

Manually adjust the score by adding positive or negative points to this box

0

Final Score

76 / 100

Meets Expectations Artifact Sample

FALL 2023 – PSYC 556: Organizational Psychology

FINAL EXAM

- You will have 2 hours for the exam.
- You will answer **5 question out of 8 options.**
- One Cheat Sheet, Double Sided, US Letter sized, will be allowed during the test.
- There will be no other use of online resources or notes.
- **Each Question is worth 20 points. Make sure to answer all areas of each question to receive full points.**
- **Incomplete answers for questions are still counted, but only the first 5 questions (or questions you've marked) will be counted in your Total Score.**

Name: Blinded

- **Question 1 (Conflict & Power/Leadership)**
 - **Your office has a manager that threatens their employees and gives certain people special treatment/benefits. Leadership has asked you to investigate the situation before they fire this manager and promote a new one.**
 - What are the Bases of Power? Define each component and which 3 seem to represent this manager.
 - In this situation, you have a *Destructive Leader*. What TWO other features would be needed to result in *destructive leadership*?
 - *Give a brief example of each related to this situation.*
 - By giving special treatment to certain employees, this manager is actually creating sub-groups among their employees
 - *What are the sub-groups that are being created?*
 - *Describe the theory that this comes from.*
 - Your new manager needs leadership qualities that have been seen to be widely effective. Please define the 4 I's of transformational leadership that will be used to hire a new manager.
- **Question 2 (Culture & Climate/ Motivation) 19/20**
 - **Your team is reorganizing the current culture to promote DEI as a focus. As a result, you start mapping out how you can encourage a stronger culture of DEI.**
 - Compare and contrast Organizational Culture and Organizational Climate. What is the difference if there is any?

A: Organizational Culture is a system of shared meaning held by members that distinguishes the organization from other organizations. It tends to be shown through materials, symbols, and stories. It can be thought of as the “why” of the organization, meaning the purpose or mission of the organization. It tends to be stable and shouldn't change much. It is influenced by organizational values , attitudes and beliefs. It is usually decided by the few highest in power. Overall, organizational culture is important

because it is an attraction and retention tool and creates focus, alignment, and is a driver of performance in organizations.

Organizational climate refers to the shared perceptions organizational members have about their organizational and work environment. You can think of this as the “What” and is sometimes thought of as team spirit at the organization. This includes things such as how things are done, habits, and behaviors. It tends to be influenced by policies, practices and procedures. It is open to change, and formed by teams, individuals, and lower-level leaders.

- What model is used to describe different types of organizational culture?
 - *You may draw and annotate your model with clear descriptions.*
 - *Provide a brief description of each type of organizational culture (not just their label).*
 - *Indicate or write out which culture you believe will encourage DEI.*

The model used to describe the different types of organizational culture is the competing values framework. It is used to understand organizational culture. It is composed of 4 things: Clan, Adhocracy, Market, and Hierarchy. Clan emphasizes flexibility and internal focus. It is focused on people, collaboration, attachment, support, and trust. Adhocracy refers to change. It emphasizes flexibility and external focus. It's innovative, encouraging, about attention to detail and stimulation. Market emphasizes stability and external focus. It's about achievement, competing (getting more gains), communication, and competence (masterful). Finally Hierarchy emphasizes stability and internal focus. It is about stability and control, having structured environment with rules, processes, and efficiency. It is focused on formalization and routine.

I believe that clan will encourage DEI because it is focused on people and collaboration. This can be particularly important for deep level diversity as we go beyond surface level characteristics (things that are visible, race, gender) and things like attitudes, values, etc. Change is also important, by definition because if we want to be more diverse, we need to change the composition of the workforce and be more flexible.

- What 4 ways can you use to help employees learn your new culture of DEI?
 - *Give a brief example for each.*
1. Stories.
 - a. Past stories about how the organization has improved the composition of the workforce from, for example, 80% white, to 30% white.
 2. Rituals
 - a. Seminars can be held in place to promote diversity.
 3. Symbols (Of values, beliefs, and judgments)
 - a. Can be something materialistic such as an LGBTQ+ flag (My mind is blank)

Instructor Feedback: Missing a fourth – Language

-1 pt

- Describe ONE motivational theory and how it can be applied to get people invested in the new culture of DEI.
 - Goal setting theory
 - Can be used to set goals to acclimate to diversity culture. For example, goal setting theory revolves around goals that are specific, challenging, and achievable. Additionally, can set short term goals to achieve a long term goal (break it down into parts).
 - By setting a specific goal to for example, engage in one learning module about diversity each week, the company can get a feel of diversity and inclusion.

• **Question 3 (Change/Justice) 18.5/20**

- **Your consulting company is merging with a larger organization. Your task is to outline what change may look like for your smaller company.**

- What are the components of Lewin's Three Step Model of Change?
 - *Briefly describe each step.*

1. Unfreeze
 - a. Changing to overcome the pressures of both individual resistance and groups conformity.
2. Movement
 - a. A change process that transforms the organization from the status quo to a desired end state.
3. Refreezing
 - a. Stabilizing a change intervention by balancing, driving and restraining forces.

- What is the major difference between Lewin's Model and Kotter's Model for implementing change? What steps overlap with Lewin's model?
 - *You may write out each of Kotter's steps or provide a clear description of Kotter's model as your answer.*

1. Establish a sense of urgency by creating a compelling reason for why change is needed.
2. Form a coalition with enough power to lead the change
3. Create a new vision to direct the change and strategies for achieving the vision
4. Communicate the vision throughout the organization
5. Empower others to act on the vision by removing barriers to change and encouraging risk taking and creative problem solving.

6. Plan for, create, and reward short-term “wins” that move the organization toward the new vision.
7. Consolidate improvements, reassess changes, and make necessary adjustments in the new programs.
8. Reinforce the changes by demonstrating the relationship between new behaviors and organizational success.

The first 5 steps are similar to unfreezing of the Lewis Model, steps 6 and 7 are similar to movement, and step 8 is similar to Refreezing. Overall, both emphasize reward and not punishment.

- For each step of Lewin’s model, define ONE form of justice that would be important in that step
 - *Define a different form of justice for each step.*
 - *Give an example of an organizational practice to promote that form of justice.*

Procedural justice refers to whether or not the procedures itself are fair (are things being done in a similar way for everyone. This could be important for the unfreezing portion because part of it could be to maintain the status quo. If the goal is to maintain the status

Informational justice (Can communicate information and is able to understand it easily.) Could be important for refreezing.

Instructor Feedback: Missing one more justice and step of change model

-1.5 pts

- **Question 4 (Stress/AET)**
 - **After some pulse surveys, your team finds out that many employees are stressed at work. There aren’t enough people for the workload and there is a lack of communication from leadership.**
 - Please define the following concepts: Stress, Stressors, and Strain
 - *Provide examples using the situation in this prompt or another workplace example.*
 - Please describe TWO Theories of Stress and their components.
 - Describe how this situation can be represented by ONE of your Theories of Stress.
 - What is Affective Events Theory?
 - *You may draw a diagram or have a written description of this theory.*
 - *Why does this relate to our experiences of stress in the workplace?*
- **Question 5 (Groups/Teams) (20/20)**
 - **You are asked to help create a new team structure for project work at your current company. This is a big change and you have to walk your leadership and employees through the process.**

- What are 3 major advantages of having a team vs individual work? What are 3 major disadvantages?

Advantages of having a team:

1. Diverse and you can get more ideas/ resources
2. Work and responsibilities are distributed
3. You are able to make changes that build trust, unity and cohesion.

Disadvantages:

1. Some people might not work well in groups (Differences in individual characteristics, ex deep level diversity, differences in values and beliefs)
2. Social Loafing (People aren't carrying their load, and expect others to compensate for them)
3. There could be potential disagreements or conflicts.
 - a. Personalities and individuals who are considered experts may get into arguments resulting in decisions that take too much time to make.
4. Can also lead to groupthink because people are too afraid to disagree with the popular belief.
 - Please describe the stages of creating a team using Tuckman's Group Developmental stages. Briefly describe each stage and describe how a leader may facilitate each stage?

1. Forming

- a. Characterized by a great deal of uncertainty about a group's purpose, structure, and leadership. People try different behaviors to see what's okay in the group. This phase ends when everyone feels like they belong in the group.

Ex. A leader can facilitate this stage by encouraging people to be themselves in a breakout room. Kind of like the first day of school at the start of the semester. People talk amongst each other, see what behavior they think is acceptable. At the end hold a group discussion to ask more questions

2. Storming

- a. This is a stage of intragroup conflict. People accept the existence of the group but dislike how it restricts their individuality. They fight about who should be in charge. When this stage ends, there is a clear hierarchy of leadership.
 - i. Manager can host a leaderless group discussion about something related to the company and see how people respond. They can each rate each others input and performance in it and see who they feel should be in charge.

3. Norming

- a. Here close relationships develop and the group demonstrates cohesiveness. There is a strong sense of group identity and there is a similar way of doing things. This stage ends when the group is solidified and has absorbed correct member behavior.
 - i. Manager can instill training to ensure everyone is on the same page and absorb the content. Going over basic rules with them in a morning meeting (similar to safety meetings)

4. Performing

- a. Here the structure is fully functional and accepted. Energy is shifted from getting to know each other to doing tasks well.

- i. Manager clearly outlines what the expectations are, asks people to complete a survey to know that they accept this and understand. Reminds people of their job descriptions and required duties in one on one meetings if they have different roles
- 5. Adjourning
 - a. This is for temporary teams, if not a temporary team then we end at the performing stage. Tends to be for wrapping up activities and preparing to disband. Some members are happy about their accomplishments, others are sad for the loss of friendship.
 - i. Manager can host a going away party/lunch after the project is complete.

▪ What are 5 barriers to effective communication?

1. Language
 - a. Different meanings and interpretations across and within languages. There might be a loss in translation.
2. Filtering
 - a. Sender's might manipulate information to be viewed more favorably.
3. Selective perception
 - a. People can have biases; they selectively interpret what they see based on interests, background, experiences, and attitude.
4. Information overload
 - a. Too much information to process; Condition in which info inflow exceeds processing capacity.

▪ What is social loafing? What are 2 things you can do to prevent social loafing?

Social Loafing is the tendency for individuals to expend less effort when working collectively than working individually. They think others will compensate for the work they do not complete.

2 things that can prevent social loafing:

1. Create smaller teams
 - a. Smaller teams make it easier to keep track of who is doing what. Also the Ringelmann effect says teams become less effective as team size increases.
2. Have some way to measure individual performance still.
 - a. If we can keep people accountable for their actions and they know they will face the consequences (termination), they will stop.

• **Question 6 (Groups/Teams) 18.5/20**

○ **Please define and describe the following as they pertain to team effectiveness.**

- What are 4 types of teams that people can engage in? Briefly describe each.

1. Cross Functional Teams

- a. Employees from about the same level hierarchical level but from different work areas come together to accomplish a task. It is an effective way to allow people from diverse areas or between organizations to exchange information, develop new ideas, and solve problems.
- 2. Problem Solving Teams
 - a. Tends to be groups of 5-12 employees from the same department who meet for a few hours each week to discuss ways of improving quality, efficiency, and the work environment.
- 3. Virtual Teams
 - a. Teams that use computer technology to tie together physically dispersed members to achieve a common goal.
- 4. Successful Teams
 - a. Here conflicts reflect debate not attacks. This introduces issues as a productive conflict, with “what if” remarks. People feel that they have a voice, meaning that individuals feel they have influence over decisions being made and control over one’s work. Rewards tend to reflect work,

Instructor Feedback: Successful teams was not one of the types of teams, you’re missing self-managed

-1.5

- What is the Ringelmann effect and what effect does it have on team effectiveness?
 - The Ringelmann effect states that teams become less effective as team size increases.
- What is Group Think and is the Ringelmann effect related to Groupthink?
 - Group think is where people in a group start thinking and making decisions in a way the prioritizes agreement and harmony over critical thinking/alternative ideas. The idea is that people are afraid to challenge what the majority of people think for the sake of group cohesion (also to not look/feel stupid).
 - In a way, it is related to the Ringelmann effect. With a large team size, people might be more likely to engage in groupthink because again, they just want to conform to what the majority of the group thinks to avoid any problems. With a smaller team, people may be more likely to participate, because they know there are less people who will hear their responses (less embarrassment). You might also be more comfortable in a smaller group because you might have closer relationships with each other, helping encourage collaboration/critical thinking.
- In developing teams, you need to consider how the task is structured to best fit a team-based environment. Please define only 2 of the following types of tasks that you may find in team settings:
 - Disjunctive

- This is a task that is completed when a single solution/decision is adopted by the group. It usually relies on the choice/idea of one person that everyone else goes along with.
- Conjunctive
- Additive
- Compensatory / Discretionary
 - Performance of the group is considered to be the average of group efforts. For example, team members all rate new hires, take the average.
- **Question 7 (Socialization/Change/Motivation) 20/20**
 - **Discuss what socialization means in the onboarding process of a new employee.**
 - Describe the socialization process and how it may relate to Lewin's Three Step Model of Change Management.
 - Socialization refers to a process that adapts employees to the organizational culture. How people are introduced to the culture affects how they interpret it. For example, do you use a presentation or brochure to illustrate the culture. Overall, it is composed of 3 Stages: The Prearrival stage, the encounter stage, and the Metamorphosis stage.
 - Prearrival
 - This is considered the learning period, and it is before actually being a part of the organization. For example, a business school might want to socialize students to attitudes and behaviors firms may want. Overall, newcomers make assumptions about that it might be like to work at an organization.
 - Encounter Stage
 - Here, people actually get a preview of the organization. This is the stage where a new employee can see what the organization is really like and confronts the possibility that their expectations and reality may diverge.
 - Metamorphosis
 - An employee changes and adjust to the job, work group, and organization.
 - How it relates to Lewis Model:
 - It can relate to the Lewis model because Socialization is about how an employee can adapt to organizational culture. The Lewis model is similar in that adaptation for the organization as a whole need to occur. When we unfreeze, we want to overcome the pressure of both individual resistance and group conformity. If the goal is to change the organization, we can use driving forces to direct behavior from the status quo (Change). This is similar to the

metamorphosis stage in which an employee changes and adjusts to the job.

- “Social Tactics” tend to be the most effective Socialization strategies: Describe the 2 types of social tactics used in socialization.
 - Serial-Disjunctive
 - Here newcomers are provided with role models or mentors that are experienced organizational members, or newcomers do not have access to role models or mentors.
 - Investiture-Divestiture
 - Here newcomers can be provided with positive social support and can affirm their personal characteristics vs being provided with more negative social feedback until newcomers adapt.
- In your own words, what is social identity theory and two forms of identification that are part of this theory?
 - A perspective that considers when and why people consider themselves to be members of groups. It refers to how much of our identity is invested into the outcomes and accomplishments of a group. People have emotional reactions to failure/success of their group because their self esteem tends to get tied in the group’s performance.
 - The two forms of identification that are part of this theory are: Relational Identification and Collective Identification
 - Relational
 - This is where a person’s identity is linked to specific relationships or connections within a group.
 - Collective
 - Here identification is with the broader group itself, focusing on shared characteristics, beliefs, and goals of the group. It prioritizes the group’s overall objectives.
- Briefly describe goal setting theory AND construct ONE goal for new employees coming into your company.
 - *Take the perspective of a Manager creating a goal for their employee.*
 - *Use the framework discussed in goal setting theory that describes the elements of an effective goal.*
 - *You may use bullet points, but it must be clear what is associated with each element of an effective goal.*
- Goal Setting Theory
 - I believe that goals need to be specific, challenging, and achievable (belief that it can be completed)
 - Goals can also be broken down into smaller goals to achieve an overarching large goal (I think?).
- Example:
 - Scenario: Say you are in manufacturing, and you work in shipping and handling.

- The average employee is able to package 20 orders of electrical parts a day but it takes time to get to this level.
- So, the goal might be, for the new employee: To complete 10 orders of electrical parts a day (Specific). Each week, you are expected to be able to complete 2 more orders until you reach the average (challenging, but achievable). Within 5-weeks you should be able to hit the average number of orders.

- **Question 8 (Conflict/Stress)**

- **You're seeking new ways to improve the well-being of your employees by targeting their work-family spillover and potential conflicts that result from it. Currently your company policy does not listen to their employees and only focus on implementing the work-family policies that suit their needs.**
 - Define the following terms:
 - Work Family Enrichment
 - Work-Family Conflict
 - Please describe the the Yerkes-Dodson Law (or Curve) and what would happen if work-family conflict was left unaddressed.
 - *Hint: There is a specific term that I am looking for here...*
 - What is the Thomas-Kilmann Conflict Model? And which type do you think represents your company (as described in the question pro`mpt)?
 - *You may draw this model and annotate with clear descriptions.*
 - What is the difference between Primary, Secondary, and Tertiary Stress Prevention Strategies?
 - *Please provide a relevant example for each one.*

Exceeds Expectations Artifact Sample

Grade by question

Results

97%
Score

97
Out of 100 points

02:38:01
Time for this attempt

1

8 / 8 points

Definition: Job evaluation

Job evaluation refers to the systematic process of translating job analysis and using it to define a salary structure by using compensable factors (skill, effort, responsibility and working conditions). This process helps in assessing the relative worth of a job in an organization.

Correct

8

/ 8 points

2

8 / 8 points

Definition: Criterion contamination

Criterion contamination occurs when a performance measure is influenced by factors that are unrelated to the theoretical construct we want to measure. It refers to variance that is introduced due to factors outside the theoretical construct that we want to measure. For example, social desirability bias.

Correct

Feedback

Feedback from grader
weak example

8

/ 8 points

3

8 / 8 points

Definition: Standard error of measurement

Standard error of measurement refers to the amount of error on an observed test score. If you give the same test to a person infinite times, SEM will be calculated as standard deviation of the test score distribution. It also reflects the precision of the test (lower SEM indicates a more reliable test).

Correct

8

/ 8 points

4

8 / 8 points

Definition: Critical incidents technique

Critical incidents technique refers to a technique used to list specific behavioural examples (good and bad) to identify key behaviors that may be needed for a job. Usually we ask SMEs to describe a situation, then the action/behavior that took place, then the consequences of that behavior. Sometimes we also ask if the consequences were within the employee's control.

Correct

8

/ 8 points

5

7 / 8 points

Definition: Range restriction

Range restriction occurs when the variability in data is artificially reduced (we have a reduced pool of candidates since we don't have performance measure of applicants who aren't hired) which reduces the overall estimate of validity. There are two types of range restriction: direct and indirect range restriction.

Graded

Feedback

Feedback from grader

Data with a limited range of test scores relative to the applicant population, due to selection decisions that directly or indirectly screen out those with low test scores. Leads to underestimates of criterion-related validity.

7

/ 8 points

Short Answer: Define and distinguish among the terms knowledge, skill, and ability. Given an example of each.

Knowledge:

Refers to the information or theoretical understanding that a person has about a subjects. This is usually acquired through education or experience. For example: A software engineer's knowledge of programming language.

Skill:

Refers to the ability of a candidate to perform a task proficiently. This is usually acquired through practice or repetition. For example:Using Excel for financial reports.

Ability:

Refers to the broad and innate capacity of an individual to perform a task or learn a skill. This is usually something innate. For example: Problem solving skills or cognitive ability.

Correct

Feedback

Feedback from grader

Whether ability is innate is a matter so some debate; better to describe as being stable/resitant to change.

15

/ 15 points

7

13 / 15 points

Short Answer: Describe two distinct ways you could estimate the reliability of scores from an employment interview. Be specific about the data you would need to collect for each method.

One way I could estimate reliability from an employment interview would be through inter-rater reliability which assesses the consistency of scores given by different interviewers. To calculate this, multiple raters would be required to independently score the candidates using a structured rating system. The data we would require would be every rater's score for the candidate for all the dimensions and then we could analyze the data to find how much agreement there is between different raters. Higher agreement would indicate higher reliability.

Another way I could estimate the reliability of scores would be through test-retest reliability. I would have the candidate do two separate but identical interviews on two separate occasions. The data that I would need is the interviewee's test scores for both interviews. A high correlation between the two sets of scores would indicate that there is high reliability. However, I would need to ensure that the time delay is optimal so that there is no practice effect.

Graded

Feedback

Feedback from grader

Both methods require a common group of interviewees (not just one)

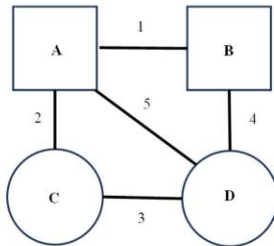
13

/ 15 points

Essay Answer only 1 of the following 2 questions. The answer should be structured as a formal essay, including complete well-formed paragraphs and a logical overall structure. Be sure that all concepts are fully explained, and that you provide a thorough rationale for all choices and conclusions (30 pts).

1. You have been hired to develop a system for assessing the job performance of OTS helpdesk staff (technology support staff) at IIT. Helpdesk staff respond to phone calls and emails from students, faculty and staff regarding technical problems (e.g., network connectivity, portal access, classroom technology failures), assist callers in solving common problems, and pass on more complex problems to appropriate technology specialists. The director of HR has expressed concerns that the current system relies on subjective supervisor ratings that are plagued by leniency and halo errors, resulting in ratings that are not useful in employee development. Discuss the pros and cons of supervisor ratings versus objective performance data. What steps should be taken to enhance the quality of supervisor ratings and their usefulness for providing developmental feedback. If your recommendations would depend on unknown information, describe how you would gather information to support your choices.
2. Describe the Binning & Barrett (1989) Unitarian model of test validity, and define each component of the model. Define the three major types of validity evidence, and how each type relates to the Unitarian model. Consider a multiple-choice knowledge test of student financial aid laws and regulations, which will be used for selecting University financial aid counselors. Using this context, provide a concrete example of each type of validity evidence, being specific about the data to be gathered and the data analysis.

If it is helpful, you can refer to the following figure when answering this question (this is optional).



In this essay I will first discuss the pros and cons of objective performance data and subjective supervisor ratings. Then I will discuss what steps can be taken to enhance the quality of supervisor ratings and their usefulness for providing developmental feedback. In case my recommendations depend on unknown data I will explain how I would gather my information to support my choices.

Subjective supervisor rating and objective performance data are both measures used to look at performance. First let's define objective performance and look at its pros and cons. Objective performance data refers to the quantifiable metrics or hard data that an organization has. This usually refers to two main categories: measure of work output (sales, production data) and personnel records (absences, errors, incident reports). However this tends to be a measure of effectiveness (results of performance) and not job performance (actions or behaviors that contribute to organizational goals). The pros of this include that the data we have is not subject to bias and is mostly easily available and easy to track. It's also standardized across employees. The cons are that this measure usually narrows and limits the views of the job and does not truly capture the nuances. It ignores the qualitative factors (like soft skills) or the reasons that someone's performance may dip (going through a difficult time/sick). The factors that are referred to here may also be influenced by outside factors like the market conditions. For example, a salesman's performance may depend on the locality that they have been assigned to or what shift they take. Also not all jobs have such easily quantifiable metrics.

Moving on to subjective measures, supervisor ratings are evaluations given by a supervisor of an employee's performance. The pros are that it captures the complexities and nuance of performance like leadership, teamwork skills which isn't captured by objective data. It's also more flexible and can be used in multiple industries. It's also better for giving feedback. However, the cons are that this is often subject to bias and subjectivity. Personal feelings and political reasons might come into play. The ratings are also less consistent since they tend to change from supervisor to supervisor. It also tends to be a bit more time-consuming.

Now let's discuss the errors that are plaguing the current system. The two errors mentioned are leniency error and halo error. Leniency error refers to the tendency of a rater to rate all ratees highly. Severity error is the opposite of this and refers to the tendency to rate all candidates low. Halo error refers to the tendency of an supervisor to see an employee as all bad or all good and give them consistently high or consistently low scores across all dimensions. This undermines the value of having multiple dimensions of performance. There also might be other errors that unintentionally come into play like central tendency (tendency to avoid the extreme ends of the rating scale and stick to the middle) or contrast effects which refers to rating employees relative of who came before them (for example, if an average employee is evaluated after a top performer, the average employee may seem worse than they are). Other things to look out for are race and gender bias.

So, now that we have discussed the errors, let's discuss what steps we can take to reduce them. One really good way of doing this is through rater training. There are various kinds of rater trainings targeting different issues. We can use Rater Error Training (RET) to advise employees on how to reduce errors, however overemphasizing on them can be harmful. There is also Performance Dimension training which defines the different performance dimension and differentiates between them. Frame of Reference (FOR) training refers to training that helps raters understand how the organization wants them to rate performance and internalize those stereotypes. This is usually done through watching videos or role-plays by people and then seeing if how the rater is evaluating them matches with the organization's expectations. We also have Observation Training which trains raters on purely observing behavior and try not making judgements immediately and documenting the behavior that they observed for later. Finally, we have Performance Feedback training which trains supervisors on giving feedback.

Let's elaborate more on increasing the usefulness for providing feedback. Feedback when given in a timely manner and in the right way has shown to be pretty

useful for helping with employee development and performance as it provides the employee with both information and motivation. It is most effective when the employee is open to it and actively takes the efforts to set goals and make a plan. There are two things that supervisors need to focus on when giving feedback: communication and goal-setting. When communicating feedback with the employee, the feedback should judge the behavior not the person and should be constructive and not just criticism (or it will just harm the employees self-esteem or result in feelings of resentment). It should also be specific (vaguely telling someone that they need to improve their report writing does not work) and frequent. The supervisor should also encourage the participant to participate (maybe by prompting them by asking how they would rate themselves) and engage in active listening.

Another extremely useful facet of feedback giving is goal-setting, which has been shown to work in many different settings. The goals must be set mutually and upon agreement by both the employee and supervisor (no use forcing them into it), should be specific, measurable and attainable and could potentially be linked to an organizational reward. However, this needs to be done carefully as we don't want to replace intrinsic motivation with extrinsic motivation or induce conflict and feelings of unfairness by linking the same rewards to different levels of goals.

Another way to improve accuracy of supervisor ratings could be through the use of different rating measures like behaviorally anchored scales (BARS). This scale reduces subjectivity by providing clear, job-related behavioral description for all performance levels. So instead of vaguely rating an employee on a 1-5 scale, BARS defines specific, observable behavior for each level from 1 to 5 which makes it difficult for subjectivity to come into play. For example, 5 on a BARS scale would be 'Quickly diagnoses technical issues and provides clear solutions' which leaves minimal room for subjective interpretation. Forced distribution could also be used to reduce leniency (it forces supervisor to rank certain percent of employees into high, middle and low) but it is often perceived as unfair.

Another way to improve accuracy would be implementing 360 degree feedback which means we would also incorporate evaluations from peers, subordinates, and the employees themselves along with supervisors. Having multiple perspectives can help give a more well-rounded, comprehensive view since each evaluator has different opportunities to observe the employee.

I think for any unknown data I would need (like additional factors affecting performance assessments or perceived fairness of current evaluations as well as thoughts about suggested changes) I would conduct anonymous surveys and interviews or have the stakeholders participate in a focus group. If a BARS was not available then I would also need to work with subject matter experts to develop one. I think looking at past performance data could also help me see if the high ratings given by supervisors correlate with objective job performance data and check if the ratings are actually inflated. I think finally I would do a trial run to see if the suggestions we made are working.

To conclude, to develop an effective performance appraisal system there must be many things taken into account. We can draw from both objective and subjective data for a balanced view of employees, since both provide us valuable insights that we would not get from the other.

Graded

30 / 30 points

Fudge Points

Manually adjust the score by adding positive or negative points to this box

0

Final Score

97 / 100

Learning Outcome 2: Clearly communicate (orally) information to a diverse group of business decision makers.

Meets Expectations Artifact Sample

Assessment Rubric Oral Communication

Evaluators: Scott &Roya **Date:**5/2/25

Student being evaluated (Degree Program): Blinded

	Oral Communication			Rating
	1 – Below Expectations	2 – Meets Expectations	3 – Exceeds Expectations	
Mechanics	Structure unclear; Main points unclear; Uninteresting slides; Hard to read/ understand; Numerous errors	Satisfactory structure and organization; Main points well stated; Transitions may be unclear; Satisfactory slides; Easy to read; Few errors	Superb structure and organization; Main points well stated; Arguments easy to follow; Engaging slides; Greatly assist in message delivery; No errors	3
Delivery	Cannot be understood; Awkward gestures/body language; Minimal eye contact with audience; Not able to answer questions	Clear voice; Few distracting gestures; Good eye contact; Answers questions but the answer is not sufficiently thorough or wasn't delivered confident	Confident delivery; Enhances the message through inflection, volume, pace; Engaging interaction with audience; Answers questions thoroughly and confidently	3

Exceeds Expectations Artifact Sample

Assessment Rubric Oral Communication

Evaluators: ___ Scott & Royal _____ **Date:** 5/2/25 _____

Student being evaluated (Degree Program): Blinded

	Oral Communication			Rating
	1 – Below Expectations	2 – Meets Expectations	3 – Exceeds Expectations	
Mechanics	Structure unclear; Main points unclear; Uninteresting slides; Hard to read/understand; Numerous errors	Satisfactory structure and organization; Main points well stated; Transitions may be unclear; Satisfactory slides; Easy to read; Few errors	Superb structure and organization; Main points well stated; Arguments easy to follow; Engaging slides; Greatly assist in message delivery; No errors	3
Delivery	Cannot be understood; Awkward gestures/body language; Minimal eye contact with audience; Not able to answer questions	Clear voice; Few distracting gestures; Good eye contact; Answers questions but the answer is not sufficiently thorough or wasn't delivered confident	Confident delivery; Enhances the message through inflection, volume, pace; Engaging interaction with audience; Answers questions thoroughly and confidently	2

Learning Objective 3: Apply I/O knowledge (i.e., personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics) to a work setting.

Meets Expectations Artifact Sample

Illinois Institute of Technology Industrial/Organizational Psychology Program Intern Evaluation Form- Supervisor

Name of Intern: _____

Organization: Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory

Location: Livermore, CA

Duration of Internship: 1yr, 2 months

Description of Internship Responsibilities: As a workforce analyst _____ is called upon to perform basic analysis as well as compiling large data sets with multiple factors and criteria from various databases to create formal and ad-hoc reports. He completes monthly, quarterly, and annual reporting for internal and external government agencies. Additionally, he is a key member of the team providing statistical analysis and analytical support to address a variety of issues requiring research and interpretation of the data.

I. Directions

1. Read each statement below and rate the importance of that item to the successful completion of this internship according to the following scale: 1 = Little Importance; 2 = Somewhat Important; 3 = Very Important.
2. For each statement below, circle the number which best corresponds to your evaluation of this inter

PERFORMANCE STATEMENT

Scale:	0	1	2	3	4	5
	N/A	Unacceptable	Marginal	Meets Requirements	Exceeds Requirements	Outstanding

Importance

<u>3</u>	1.	Arrives on time for daily or scheduled activities.				
	0		1	2	3	4
						5
<u>3</u>	2.	Completes assignments within designated time frame.				
	0		1	2	3	4
						5
<u>3</u>	3.	Plans and organizes own time effectively.				
	0		1	2	3	4
						5

Scale:	0 N/A	1 Unacceptable	2 Marginal	3 Meets Requirements	4 Exceeds Requirements	5 Outstanding
<u>3</u>	4. 0	Performs tasks with minimal supervision. 1	2	③	4	5
<u>3</u>	5. 0	Demonstrates initiative in approaching and carrying out assignments. 1	2	3	④	5
<u>3</u>	6. 0	Makes effective use of available resources (e.g., staff, equipment, reference materials) 1	2	③	4	5
<u>3</u>	7. 0	Assumes a practical orientation to business realities. 1	2	③	4	5
<u>3</u>	8. 0	Generates alternative approaches/solutions to problem solving. 1	2	3	④	5
<u>3</u>	9. 0	Demonstrates technical competence in area of expertise. 1	2	3	④	5
<u>3</u>	10. 0	Produces professional quality work. 1	2	3	④	5
<u>3</u>	11. 0	Clearly expresses technical or complex information to others outside his/her field of expertise. 1	2	3	4	⑤
<u>3</u>	12. 0	Relates to others in a non-condescending manner (not a know-it-all). 1	2	3	4	⑤
<u>3</u>	13. 0	Makes formal presentations in a well organized and professional manner. 1	2	3	④	5
<u>3</u>	14. 0	Maintains good interpersonal relationships with co-workers. 1	2	3	④	5
<u>3</u>	15. 0	Uses oral communication skills effectively. 1	2	3	④	5
<u>3</u>	16. 0	Uses written communication skills effectively. 1	2	3	④	5

IIT Intern Evaluation Form - Page 3

II. Comments

1. How would you summarize this individual's performance strengths?: _____

_____ has a talent for assimilating new information quickly. He has great communication skills that he uses with our customers and team members when collaborating on team projects and data requests.

2. What suggestions do you have for improving this individual's professional skills?: _____

_____ has learned a lot over the past year, he should continue to get involved in new projects, as well as continuing to develop his skills in developing HR Dashboards.

Thank you for your cooperation in completing this evaluation form.

Ross A. Anderson

Digitally signed by Ross A. Anderson
Date: 2023.05.01 17:01:13 -07'00'

Signature

Date

Please send the completed form to: Roya Ayman, Ph.D.

Director
Industrial and Organizational
Psychology Program
Illinois Institute of Technology
3101 South Dearborn
Chicago IL 60616

Fax: (312)567-3493

Exceeds Expectations Artifact Sample

Illinois Institute of Technology
Industrial/Organizational Psychology Program
Intern Evaluation Form- Supervisor

Name of Intern: [REDACTED]

Organization: HumanID - Foundation for a Human Internet

Location: New York City, NY (Remote)

Duration of Internship: 4 months

Description of Internship Responsibilities: Recruiting candidates through H
Audit, suggest, and help implement changes to the org's c
Collect, analyze, then present data from internal surveys

I. Directions

1. Read each statement below and rate the importance of that item to the successful completion of this internship according to the following scale: 1 = Little Importance; 2 = Somewhat Important; 3 = Very Important.
2. For each statement below, select the number from the dropdown menu which best corresponds to your evaluation of this intern's performance.

			<u>PERFORMANCE STATEMENT</u>				
Scale:	0	1	2	3	4	5	
	N/A	Unacceptable	Marginal	Meets Requirements	Exceeds Requirements	Outstanding	
<u>Importance</u>	<u>Performance</u>						
2	5	1.	Arrives on time for daily or scheduled activities.				
3	5	2.	Completes assignments within designated time frame.				
3	5	3.	Plans and organizes own time effectively.				
3	5	4.	Performs tasks with minimal supervision				
3	5	5.	Demonstrates initiative in approaching and carrying out assignments.				
2	5	6.	Makes effective use of available resources (e.g., staff, equipment, reference materials)				

IIT Intern Evaluation Form - Page 2
PERFORMANCE STATEMENT - Continued

Scale:	0 N/A	1 Unacceptable	2 Marginal	3 Meets Requirements	4 Exceeds Requirements	5 Outstanding
<u>Importance</u>	<u>Performance</u>					
3	5	7.	Assumes a practical orientation to business realities.			
2	4	8.	Generates alternative approaches/solutions to problem solving.			
3	5	9.	Demonstrates technical competence in area of expertise.			
3	4	10.	Produces professional quality work.			
2	5	11.	Clearly expresses technical or complex information to others outside his/her field of expertise.			
2	5	12.	Relates to others in a non-condescending manner (not a know-it-all).			
2	5	13.	Makes formal presentations in a well organized and professional manner.			
3	5	14.	Maintains good interpersonal relationships with co-workers.			
2	5	15.	Uses oral communication skills effectively.			
2	5	16.	Uses written communication skills effectively.			

IIT Intern Evaluation Form - Page 3

II. Comments

1. How would you summarize the individual's performance strengths?

Excellent at communication, offers nuance to conversations about how to best care for and support employees. Is open to and frequently requests feedback from team membe

2. What suggestions do you have for improving this individual's professional skills?

██████ is incredibly professional, and I think they will go far in the HR field! I would suggest finding a mentor that's worked in HR/IO Psych/Data Science for a good portion of their career.

Thank you for your cooperation in completing this evaluation form.



Signature

08/30/2024

Date

Please send the completed form to: Roya Ayman, Ph.D.

Director
Industrial and Organizational
Psychology Program
Illinois Institute of Technology
3101 South Dearborn
Chicago, IL 60616

Fax: (312)567-3493